

GANPAT UNIVERSITY
(Acharya Motibhai Patel Institute of Computer Studies)
FCA Semester – I
Communication Skills
Unit: 1 - Basics of Communication

Introduction:

Human beings can't live in society without communication. We can find that people involve in several activities like informal conversations, discussions, phone calls, teleconferencing, gossiping, chatting, net surfing and so on. In short, we need to communicate in order to interact. Basically communication is a systematic effort to share human expressions, thoughts, ideas, feelings, attitudes, information knowledge with one or more than one persons.

The word Communication is derived from the Latin term – "*Communicare*" which means **To share, To Transmit or To Impart.**

Definition & Principles of Communication:

Principles of communication:

- Communication is a two-way process
- Communication is a continuous and systematic process
- Communication requires proper co-ordination and co-operation between the two parties (Sender and Receiver)
- Communication is always a contextual phenomenon.
- Communication is irreversible.
- Medium is a mandatory requirement in communication because no communication is possible without a medium.

There are four skills of communication – where Listening and Reading are receptive skills whereas Writing and Speaking are Productive Skills.

Listening:

Everyday conversations with colleagues and top management, telephonic talks, expert lectures, attending presentations, interviews, panel discussions, meetings, parliament sessions, press conferences and media interviews,

seminars/workshops/conferences/conventions/exhibitions etc.

Reading:

Reading of newspapers, e-mails, reports, business letters, text books, reference books, story-books, novels etc.

Writing:

Business and official Letters, e-mails, reports, drafts of advertisements etc.

Speaking:

Everyday formal conversations, conducting meetings, facing interviews, making effective presentations, participation in debates and panel discussions, delivering public addresses etc.

Definitions:

- “Communication can be defined as the exchange of information, ideas and knowledge between sender and receiver through an accepted code of language.”

- “Communication is the activity or process of expressing ideas and feelings or giving people information.”

-Oxford Advanced Learning Dictionary of Correct English

- “Communication is the process by which information is transmitted between individuals and/or organizations so that an understanding response results.||

-Peter Little

- “Communication is a process of passing information and understanding from one person to another.”

-The American Management Association

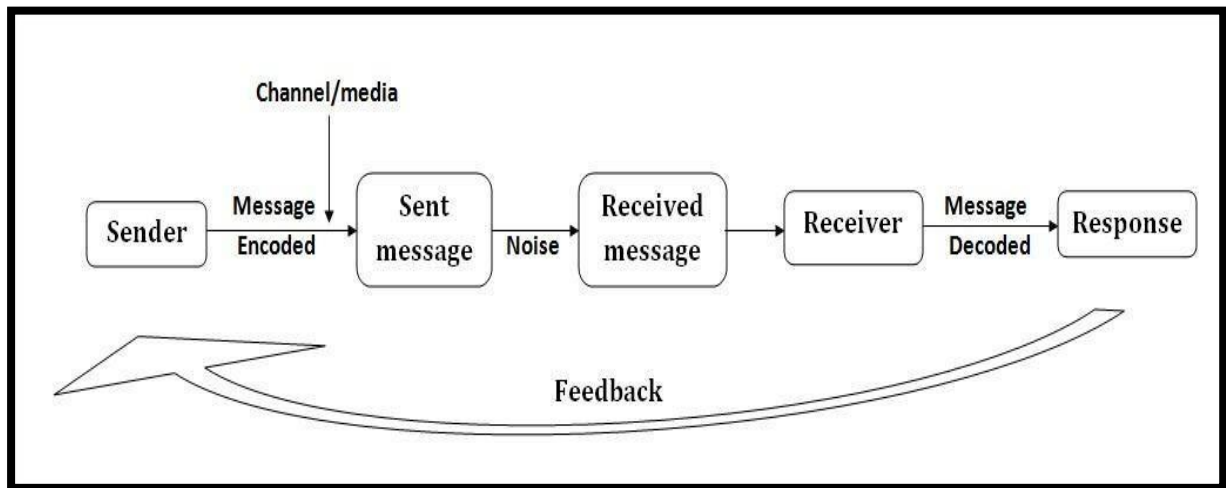
- “Communication is the process of exchanging ideas, thoughts, feelings, emotions, information, knowledge as well as attitude by words (oral or written), sign or symbols.”

The Process of Communication:

The above mentioned definitions reveal some striking features of Communication.

- Communication takes place between sender and receiver
- Exchange of information between them.
- This exchange is done through a specific medium/channel

The process of communication can be understood as a seven-step procedure with the help of the following figure:



- **Sender:**

The process of communication starts with a sender, the person who has an idea, knowledge, thoughts, feelings which are in abstract form. Sender tries to give these abstract thoughts a physical and concrete shape in the form of commonly accepted codes.

- **Encoding:**

Encoding is the next step in the communication process. Before sending the message, the sender encodes the message because the message is basically in abstract form. This encoding process is done in order to give abstract thought into a concrete shape.

- **Message:**

The message itself is oral, written or non verbal. The communications are affected by the sender's tone and method. Message has intellectual and emotional components. With intellect the sender has the ability to present reason and with emotion to present the motivational appeals.

- **Medium/Channel:**

It is a vehicle through which a message is carried from the sender to the receiver. The mediums of communication are many-written, oral, verbal, non-verbal, mass media like TV, radio, newspapers, books, etc. It is a complicated task to choose the appropriate medium. Success and failure depends on the selection of the right channel.

- **Noise:**

Noise is defined as any unplanned interference in the communication environment, because of that creates a barrier in communication. Noise prevents the interpretation of the message. Background noise, noise in telephone line, high volume are the examples of noise.

- **Receiver:**

At the end of communication process, the receiver is the recipient of the message. The receiver gets the message, understands and tries to provide the total meaning of the message as transmitted by the sender. This process is done with the help of another process called decoding.

- **Decoding:**

Decoding is very important part of the process of communication where the receiver tries to understand the message of the sender. The process of decoding involves interpretation and analysis of the message. Effective decoding is very important for successful communication because any misinterpretation of the message creates confusion and misunderstanding.

- **Feedback:**

It is the last stage in the process of communication. It is the action or reaction of the receiver to the message. It helps the sender know that the message was received and understood. The response is based on perfect understanding of the message. The success and failure of communication is decided by feedback only. Feedback is essential as it is a barometer of effective communication.

Functions:

No communication is purposeless. Communication performs following functions.

- To inform/ To educate/ To explain/ To train

Examples: a Teacher to the students, a Trainer to the trainees

- To inquire

Examples: a Customer to a Relationship officer of a bank

- To request

Examples: A junior executive to the superior

- To order / To instruct

Examples: A senior officer to the junior executive

- To persuade / To Convince

Example: A salesperson to the customer

- To sympathize / to console

Example: One friend to another friend, One relative to another relative

- To appreciate / To motivate / To inspire

Example: A father to the son, Audience to the artist

- To warn / To threaten

Example: A supervisor to the worker

- To entertain etc.

Examples: A joker to the audience

Modes & Methods of Communication:

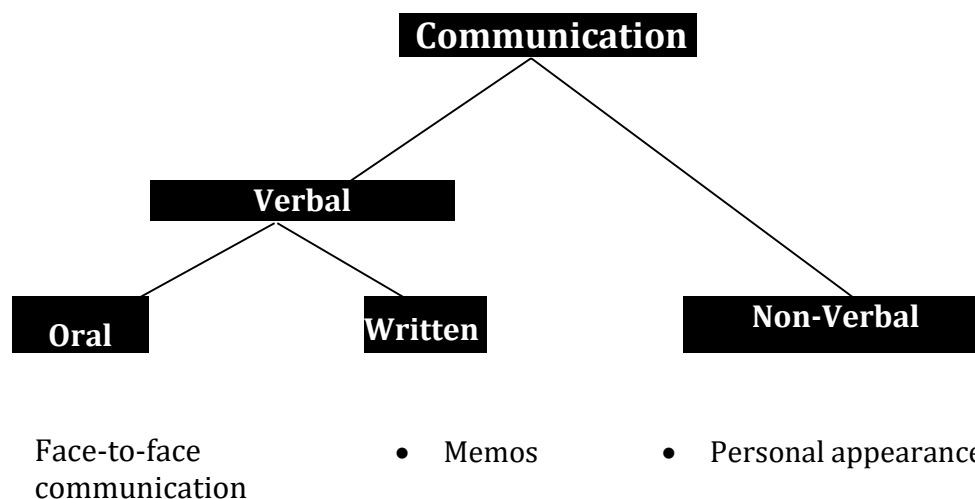
Modes:

- Formal and Informal
- Verbal and Non-verbal

Methods:

- Verbal: Oral, Written
- Non-verbal: Facial Expressions, Gestures, Body Language (Postures), Signs, Signals, Pictures, Map,
- Chart, Graph, Colour, Silence

Components of Non-Verbal Communication



- Telephonic Conversation
- Meeting
- Seminar
- Conference
- Dictation
- Instruction
- Presentation
- Group discussions
- Interviews
- Video conference
- Voice conference
- Reports
- Proposals
- Letters
- Notices
- News Letters
- Bulletins
- Journals
- E-mail
- Faxes
- Circulars
- Research papers
- Brochures
- Gesture
- Posture
- Facial expression
- Eye contact
- Sign, Symbol, & Signal
- Charts, Maps & Graphs
- Silence

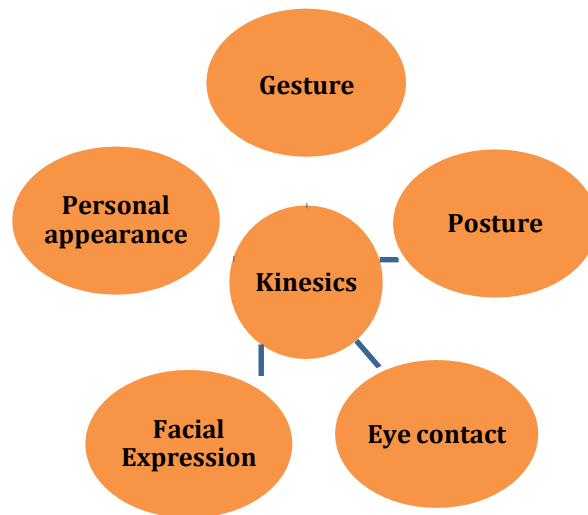
Components of Non-Verbal Communication

Kinesics Paralinguistic Proxemics Chronemics

Kinesics:

Kinesics is the interpretation of body language such as facial expression and gestures or, more formally, non-verbal behaviour.

- **Definition:** “Kinesics is the interpretation of body language such as facial expressions and gestures or, more formally, non – verbal behavior related to movement, either of any part of the body as a whole.”



(a) Gestures:

It refers to the body movements, which support and emphasize the state of mind of an individual. These are the specific mute codes performed by the human body, which can note a message better than the talk.

(b) Posture:

It refers to the way we sit, stand and carry ourselves. It communicates the way we visualize the world around us. Therefore, a professional has to maintain and cultivate elegance in his/ her sitting, standing and walking posture.

(c) Eye Contact:

Eye contact is important for both the sender as well as the receiver in face to face communication. It sends and receives feedback. It expresses emotions and gives instructions. Not maintaining eye contact indicates lack of confidence on the part of speaker and disinterest on the part of listener.

(d) Facial expressions:

Face is an index of mind. It is the real presenter of human emotions and wish. By reading face of an individual, one can guess about his/her personality and mood in which he is running at the moment of interaction.

(e) Personal Appearance:

It is the most impressive as well as depressive part of a person. It constitutes your whole appearance with positive outlook and smile on face. It is the stating key of nonverbal impression, which you want to make upon the audience. It is as much as the gorgeous interior of a house.

Paralanguage:

(1) Pitch: Pitch is the highness or lowness of the voice; it is similar to pitch on a musical scale. We associate higher pitches with female voices and lower pitches with male voices. We associate low-pitched voices with strength, sexiness, and maturity, and high-pitched voices with helplessness, tension, and nervousness.

We also vary our pitch to reflect our mood and interest in conversing. Your pitch expresses your emotional state; or making a statement or asking a question.

(2) Volume: The power of your voice, its loudness or volume, also affects perceptions of intended meaning. Some whisper or blast through their volume. An aggressive person is often very louder. In contrast, if you are soft spoken, others may take your behavior nervousness. Effective Interpersonal Communicators Regulate Volume in an Effort to Promote Meaningful Interaction. Your volume should reflect the nature of your message.

(3) Pace/Rate: Speaking rate is the third vocal signal affecting the communication of meaning. Most of us speak at an average rate of 150 words per minute. When we speed up our speech, exceeding 275 to 300 words per minute, it is difficult for others to comprehend what we are saying, and our message thus becomes virtually unintelligible. In contrast, if we speak too slowly, others may perceive us as tentative or lacking in confidence or intelligence. It quickens to relay agitation, excitement, and happiness, and it falls to convey seriousness, serenity, or sadness.

(4) Articulation and Pronunciation: The sound attributes of articulation and pronunciation affect message intelligibility as well as perceptions of credibility. Articulation is the way you pronounce individual sounds. Ideally, even during person-to-person contact, the sounds of your speech are sharp and distinct. When you fail to utter a final sound (a final *t* or *d*, for example), fail to produce the sounds of words properly. When you mispronounce a word, you may suffer a loss of credibility, and those listening to you may find it more difficult to make sense of what you are saying.

(5) Voice Modulation: Intonation refers to the tonal variation, modulation pertains to the way we regulate, vary, or adjust the tone, pitch, and volume of the sound or speaking voice. Modulation of voice brings flexibility and vitality to your voice, and you can express emotions, sentiments, impatience, careful planning, despondency and suspicions etc. If you do not pay special attention to the modulation of your voice, then your voice becomes flat. Word stress and sentence stress also play an important role in voice modulation.

(6) Hesitations and Silence: Hesitations and silence are the final paralinguistic variables we will consider here. Knowing when to pause is a critical skill. When nervous or tense, we may exhibit a tendency to fill all pauses. Some time we insert meaningless sounds or phrases such as *uh*, *you know*, or *okay* in the effort to fill voids. These **non-fluencies**, or hesitation phenomena, disrupt the natural flow of speech and adversely affect how others perceive your competence and confidence.

Proxemics:

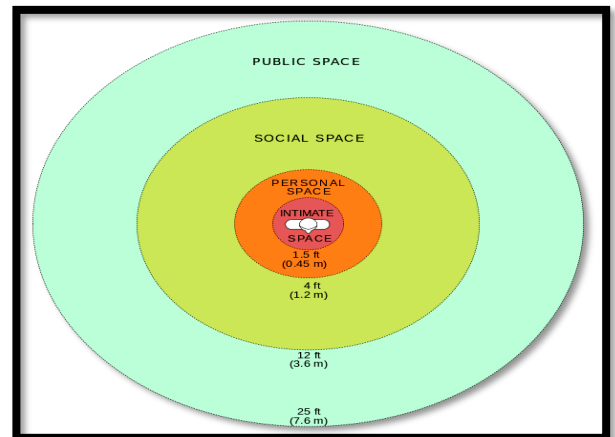
The word proxemics is derived from 'Proximity' which means 'nearness'. Proximity is the study of how people interact. The custom and culture of the country also affect the person to make proximity

Definition:

“The study of man’s transaction as he perceives and uses intimate, personal, social and public space in various settings while following out of awareness dictates of cultural paradigms” (Hall, 1947).

(1) Intimate Distance:

This zone extends from zero to eighteen inches from the person. There are two phase – zero to six inches is a close phase and six to eighteen inches is a far phase. An intimate distance include the person’s body, sound, smell and feel of the breath all combine to signal unmistakable involvement with another body. Strangers are not invited into the intimate zone by adult, middle class Americans.



(2) Personal Distance:

The personal zone extends from one and one half to four feet, with a near phase extending to two and one half feet and a far phase beyond that. Personal space changes depending on culture, upbringing, and relationship to the individual and expectations. We have an invisible boundary that allows us to be comfortable because intruders may not enter. The personal zone allows a variety of both formal and non-formal contact between people. “It is a zone that people use in public, and it seems to be a ‘normal’ contact distance that enables people to remain in reasonable proximity or to move toward more or less personal communication. Perfumes, colognes or deodorants may be detectable, if used, and fine details of the face and clothing can be detected visually with little perceived distortion.

(3) Social Distance:

This zone spans from four to twelve feet, the close phase extending from four to seven feet and the far phase from seven to twelve feet. The boundary line is between the far phase of personal distance and the close phase of social distance marks, in the words of one subject, the “limit of domination.” Social distance is typically used in business settings, among people who are working together, and in more formal social situations.

(4) Public Distance:

The public distance zone extends from twelve feet on out, with a close phase from twelve to twenty feet and far phase beyond that. The close phase in terms of self defence, and also sensory shifts that occur at a separation of about twelve feet. The sensory shifts associated with this distance are speech which becomes loud although not shouting.

The far phase is truly public. At this distance people tend to be perceived “in a setting” rather than the person filling the entire stage of attention. In this phase voice and details of facial expression are lost at this distance, and voice, gestures and expressive movements must be exaggerated.

Chronemics:

Chronemics is the study of how we use time to communicate. Some of us are preoccupied with time, while others regularly waste it. Some of us are typically early, while others are chronically late. Some of us are early birds, functioning best in the morning, while others, night owls, perform best at night.

Misunderstandings, miscalculations, and disagreements involving time can create communication and relationship problems. What does it mean to be “on time”? How is the concept of punctuality construed?

Status affords us greater power to control both our own time and others’ time. The more status a person has, the longer others with less status will wait to see him or her.

Importance of Time: In professional world, time is valuable commodity. When you are late for an appointment, people react negatively. If you arrive early, you are considered over eager. As a speaker, your awareness of schedule is a chronemic element.

Our culture influences how we use and think about time. In some cultures people live for today, but in others they are waiting for tomorrow. Thus, even the meaning of the phrase “a long time” is influenced by how a culture’s members conceive of time. There are two dominant time patterns: (1) Monochronic time and, (2) Polychronic time

(1) Monochronic time: A monochronic time system means that things are done one at a time and time is segmented into small units. Under this system time is scheduled, arranged and managed.

- People in Monochronic time culture pay attention to clock time and do one thing at a time
- People in Monochronic time usually engage in one activity at a time. They tend to separate tasks.
- Time is a tangible commodity
- Members of individualistic cultures tend to follow the Monochronic time pattern
- Monochronic cultures include Germany, Canada, Switzerland, United States, and Scandinavia.
- Monochronic committed to the job
- Monochronic People are concerned about not disturbing others; follow rules of privacy and consideration.

(2) Polychronic time: A polychronic time system is a system where several things can be done at once, and a more fluid approach is taken to scheduling time. Unlike Americans and most northern and western European cultures, Latin American and Arabic cultures use the polychronic system of time.

- People in polychronic time pay attention to relational time and may be involved in many simultaneous activities.
- People in polychronic time tend to engage in multiple activities at the same time
- Time is a relational issue rather than a clock time issue.

- Members of collectivistic cultures tend to follow the polychronic time pattern.
- Polychronic cultures include Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Mexico, Philippines, India, and many in Africa.
- Many polychronic cultures have a past-orientation toward time
- Polychronic cultures are committed to people and human relationships
- Polychronic People are more concerned with those who are closely related than with privacy

Five major forms of communication:

- Intrapersonal Communication
- Dyadic Communication
- Small Group Communication
- Public Communication
- Mass Communication

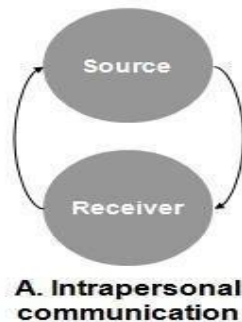


Fig. A. Intrapersonal Communication

Intrapersonal communication is communication which happens by yourself. Here both Source (sender) and receiver is only one. So, the feedback works without any interruption. Example: A person can communicate himself through pain, thinking, feelings and emotion etc.

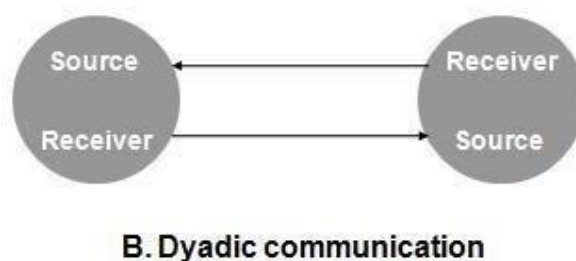
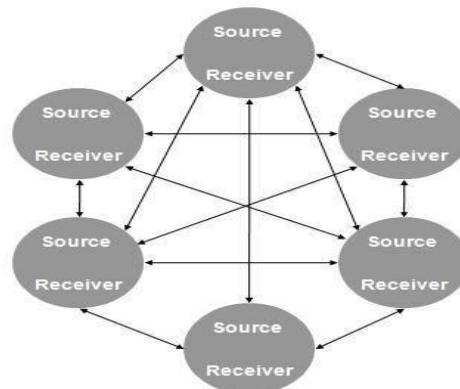


Fig. B. Dyadic Communication

In Dyadic communication, two persons are involved in this communication process. Here the Source becomes a receiver and receiver becomes Source because of dynamic communication

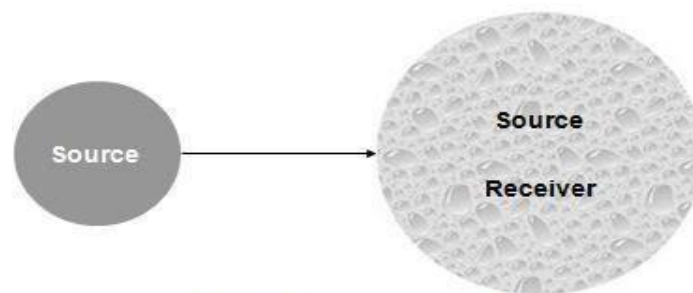
processes where the feedback is shared between Source and the receiver.



C. Small group communication

Fig. C. Small Group Communication

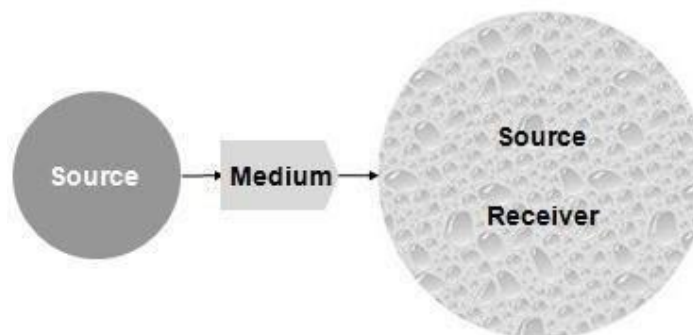
More than two members involved in the communication process will become a group communication. If the least number of persons is involved in the group communication is called small group communication. In this communication process, everyone becomes a Source as well as receiver through sharing information and giving feedback to another.



D. Public communication

Fig. D. Public Communication

In public communication, Source or messages from a single person will reach or be received by a huge number of audience. But in this communication there is no mutual feedback between source and receiver like small group communication and it's only focused on Speaker.



E. Mass communication

Fig. E. Mass Communication

In mass communication, basically have a large number of audience and they are all can't grouped together in one place so we need certain tool or technology for communication process. But in mass communication, there is no direct access with the receiver. So, for that they need media like newspapers, radio, television and internet. Here the audience feedback is very less or delayed.

Source: [Forms of Communication \(communicationtheory.org\)](http://communicationtheory.org)

Functions of communication:

Functions of communication is an important sub-topic of communication as it explains in detail the purpose of the communication process.

The primary function of communication is about communicating your ideas, thoughts, information, opinions and views and sharing messages with others in the most effective manner. It is used as a powerful tool in both personal and professional spaces to communicate your vital needs, goals, desires and boost interpersonal relationships.

Excellent communication skills have become a desired quality in the current scenario because it is believed that employees with this soft skill will have a good edge above others. Every business entity has now made it one of their mandatory requirement while hiring new employees



The 8 essential functions of communication are as follows-

1. Informative Function

One of the basic communication functions is to provide information.

If you are a child then in school and college the communication process with a teacher helps to gain knowledge and develop skills that will prove useful later on in choosing the best career option for yourself.

Communication is also used as a medium of expression in social organizations. Human activities are dependent on being communicative and using proper language and

speech to communicate your feelings and ideas with other people

In business, Informative Functions of communication prove useful in sharing essential information, facts, views and opinions with the stakeholders, clients and customers. Communication is also used by the people in management and leadership roles to inform, guide, persuade and influence an employee on the various decisions, processes, policies and procedures that are required for the effective running of the organization.

Informative communication helps to promote the products of an organization in the consumer market, inform the public about new products and act as an official statement from the company.

Example – The job of the PR department of a company is to release regular press releases so that it can inform the public and the stakeholders regarding all the development happening in the company.

2. Instructive Function

Human activities are dependent to a great extent on interactions and communication. Instructive communication is about providing essential instructions so that people can make informed choices.

This type of communication is most common in the military, family, schools, colleges and business where a hierarchical order is followed to instruct and command subordinates and complete the given tasks.

In business organizations, people in leadership and management roles share valuable information with their subordinates to instruct them on how, when and why to do things in a specific way. Various opportunities for training and upskilling are offered to the employees for instructive communication purposes.

Communicating the way things are done and are needed to be done in future is an important business activity as it helps an employee to get accustomed to the organization and achieve excellent job performance.

The Instructive communication provides information about the workplace environment and helps an employee in moulding his opinions and decisions to safeguard their interest and suit the organizational culture

Examples – The employee handbook with a set of instructions is provided by organizations so that the employees can know and understand topics like core values, workplace benefits, goals and essential practices that are important for the organization.

3. Persuasive Function

In normal life, people take the help of persuasive communication to change the attitude of other people and sway them towards their way of thinking.

A mom can persuade her children with a toy and sweet messages whereas children can sway their parents and group of friends to their way of thinking with their sweet talk, attitude, communication and good behaviour. A teacher takes the help of teaching materials and persuades a child with an encouraging word so that he can do better in class

Persuasive communication helps managers and leaders in an organization to influence the opinion and decisions of other workforce, clients and customers. They share vital information, views, new ideas and techniques that persuade other people in proving a point, accepting their claim and work accordingly.

The communicative goal of an organization is to bring its workforce together and build interpersonal relationships so that everyone can work harmoniously in the workplace. Persuasive communication makes sure that the flow of information is smooth and has resulted in better understanding between the workers.

Example – Business organizations take the help of promotional gimmicks related to their product to persuade potential customers in buying their products and services.

4. Motivation Function

The Motivation communication function uses a person's desire to communicate to motivate them in coming out of their shell. Goal formation, feedback and reward are necessary tools to stimulate motivation

A motivated person plays an active role in a company and this is why organizations hold meetings, events and seminars to tell the workers what is required from them, how well they are performing their duties and instruct them in the ways to improve their performance. Success stories of people who have overcome the odds and achieved their goals are shared on such occasions to encourage other personnel to do their best.

The motivational communication model in business organizations is used by people in management and leadership roles to boost employee confidence. It is quite useful in enticing people to take a step further for their betterment. This leads to improved efficiency and productivity and helps both the employees and the organization to reach their goals and objectives.

Examples – Business organizations use motivating comments, encouraging words, an inspiring message, optimistic speech, positive language, certificates of good work,

award money, cash-in-points and gratitude in front of other workers to express their appreciation for exceptional work and motivate them to do better

5. Aesthetic Function

Aesthetic communication helps in fulfilling social needs as it becomes easy to display emotional expression, frustration and satisfaction.

The Aesthetic function of communication takes the help of language and art form to give a realistic presentation of the subject matter and explain the conceptual meaning. Verbal expressions and art forms are used to explore innovation, development and creativity.

This function of communication is used to boost social routines and cultural development. In daily life, it helps an individual to interpret and understand the information that is conveyed between people, in the media and cultural life.

In a business entity, the Aesthetic function of communication encourages the workforce to develop skills, tools and techniques for positive interactions with different team members as well as clients and customers. It puts the focus on understanding and interpreting the expectation and emotions of other people and identifying the right way to communicate with every stakeholder in the correct environment.

Example – Business organizations conduct communication seminars where they help workers to understand how skills, knowledge and creativity can be aligned to create an effective communicative process that can be used in different contexts.

6. Therapeutic Function / Emotional Expression

Therapeutic Function is one of the most important functions of the communication process that helps to improve the emotional well-being of a person.

In school life, a child is encouraged to talk to his teacher or a counsellor to sort out any dilemmas regarding academic standing and in case of bullying and harassment at the hands of fellow students or even teachers.

In business organizations employees are encouraged to talk to counsellors provided by the company as well as their friends in the organization to deal with issues related to both personal and professional life.

Business houses also encourage monthly meetings where every employee can talk about anything and everything without the fear of repercussions. It is a fact that talking about the different issues one is facing is self-therapeutic by nature as people feel much better after emotional outbursts. Therapeutic Functions of communication is the best way for people in a workplace to share their feelings of satisfaction and

even frustrations.

Examples – Counsellors often encourage employees to maintain a journal where they can write their thoughts and viewpoint. It helps to vent out their negative feelings and cleanse their mind. A gratitude journal is another way to encourage positivity in life.

7. Regulation / Control

The Regulation/Control functions of communication show how people use interactions to control the behaviour of other people.

In personal life, parents use it to reprimand their child in case of any mischief or out-of-the-way behaviour. A teacher uses regulation and control to inspire a child and guide him towards better conduct

In the workplace, the Regulations and Control functions of communication are used by management to maintain control over their employees and direct their efforts to better channels. They are encouraged to learn new skills, incorporate good values, gain advanced knowledge and develop competencies along with a positive attitude and behavior.

Example – Business entities have specific rules and regulations as well as a code of conduct and formal guidelines in place that will curb any unwanted behavior and attitude of their employees.

8. Social Interaction

One of the functions of communication is to help in social interactions. Starting a conversation with other people, greeting them cordially, establishing warm relationships and even ending a relationship with grace is part of social interaction in daily life.

In business, communication helps employees to maintain a good relationship with subordinates, peers, managers and colleagues. It is a basic tool that helps to converse cordially at the workplace, exchange information, identify your shortcomings, understand the behavior of other workers, understand their actions and accommodate the difference in opinions, beliefs and thoughts.

Examples – International companies like Deloitte have conducted special communication seminars where they educate their employees about the struggles faced by LGBTQ communities so that the rest of the employees show tolerance towards them

Source: [The 8 Functions of Communication - Digiade.com](https://digiade.com)

Flow of Communication:

It's one of the most critical skills for success in the workplace: communication. Whether you are a technical genius or a marketing maven, effective conversation with peers, management, and clients is the first rung in the ladder to success at the workplace. Communication is also essential for effective teamwork and building a positive company culture. One of the key factors that determine workplace communication is an organization's hierarchy. Organizational communication needs to be structured for the smooth functioning of an organization. How does organizational communication flow?

Types of Communication Flow in an Organization:

Let's understand the different types of communication flow in an organization:

The Downward Flow of Communication:

Most people associate organizational communication with downward communication. This refers to the formal process of relaying information to employees through a chain of command. The downward flow of communication transfers information from a higher level to a lower level in an organization.

Typically, top-level managers use downward communication to provide information to employees on company objectives, strategies, policies, and procedures. They use speeches, meetings, memos, and messages to get their message across to all employees.

So what's the exact role of downward communication? It is used in the following ways:

- Giving Instructions And Information Required For The Job
- Providing Feedback On An Employee's Performance
- Communicating The Organization's Mission And Vision To The Employees
- Helping Employees Understand The Structure Of Their Job

The Upward Flow of Communication:

Another key form of communication is upward communication, in which information travels from lower levels to higher levels in an organization. Upward communication reduces frustration among employees, enables supportive structures to be put in place, and fosters cooperation. You can think of many other upward communication flow examples in an organization: requests, estimations, complaints, proposals, and so on.

Let's say you're a team leader and your project is facing some technical problems. You

know there's a real chance of your team missing the deadline on a crucial project. What do you do? You go to your manager and request to speak with the client regarding a deadline extension. This is upward communication in an organization.

Horizontal communication:

Now, let's turn to another form of communication: lateral communication or horizontal communication. Horizontal communication takes place when individuals at the same level in the organization exchange messages. This is a type of communication we are all familiar with, especially when we work in teams with our peers. A team meeting to coordinate tasks and iron out any confusion is a good place to see horizontal communication flow.

Diagonal Communication:

Here, information is shared within different levels and different departments of the organization. This kind of communication often happens in cross-functional teams. And just like cross-functional teams, diagonal communication has become the norm in today's nimble and multidisciplinary workplace. Channels of diagonal communication must be opened to make information sharing faster. In this communication flow, you can directly communicate with a counterpart without the message getting tempered, filtered, or carried in any other way by superiors or juniors.

External Communication:

External communication is when the organization initiates communication with people or groups outside the business. Conversation with a client—whether verbal or written—is a good example of external communication flow. Any kind of shop talk with potential vendors, existing suppliers, or the public at large also falls within the category of external communication. These conversations are often handled by the sales and marketing teams.

Understanding the different types of organizational communication is critical for effective communication. To take the first step towards being an effective communicator, sign up for Harappa's [Speaking Effectively](#) course.

Source: [Communication Flow: Downward and Upward Communication | Harappa Education](#)

Barrier to Effective Communication:

The process of communication has multiple barriers. The intended communicate will often be disturbed and distorted leading to a condition of misunderstanding and failure of communication. The Barriers to effective communication could be of many types like linguistic, psychological, emotional, physical, and cultural etc. We will see all of these types in detail below.

The Barriers to effective communication:

Linguistic Barriers:

The language barrier is one of the main barriers that limit effective communication. Language is the most commonly employed tool of communication. The fact that each major region has its own language is one of the Barriers to effective communication. Sometimes even a thick dialect may render the communication ineffective.

As per some estimates, the dialects of every two regions change within a few kilometers. Even in the same workplace, different employees will have different linguistic skills. As a result, the communication channels that span across the organization would be affected by this.

Psychological Barriers:

There are various mental and psychological issues that may be barriers to effective communication. Some people have stage fear, speech disorders, phobia, depression etc. All of these conditions are very difficult to manage sometimes and will most certainly limit the ease of communication.

Emotional Barriers:

The emotional IQ of a person determines the ease and comfort with which they can communicate. A person who is emotionally mature will be able to communicate effectively. On the other hand, people who let their emotions take over will face certain difficulties.

A perfect mixture of emotions and facts is necessary for effective communication. Emotions like anger, frustration, humour, can blur the decision-making capacities of a person and thus limit the effectiveness of their communication.

Physical Barriers to Communication:

They are the most obvious barriers to effective communication. These barriers are mostly easily removable in principle at least. They include barriers like noise, closed doors, faulty equipment used for communication, closed cabins, etc. Sometimes, in a large office, the physical separation between various employees combined with faulty equipment may result in severe barriers to effective communication.

Cultural Barriers of Communication:

As the world is getting more and more globalized, any large office may have people from several parts of the world. Different cultures have a different meaning for several basic values of society. Dressing, Religions or lack of them, food, drinks, pets, and the general behaviour will change drastically from one culture to another.

Hence it is a must that we must take these different cultures into account while

communicating. This is what we call being culturally appropriate. In many multinational companies, special courses are offered at the orientation stages that let people know about other cultures and how to be courteous and tolerant of others.

Organizational Structure Barriers:

As we saw there are many methods of communication at an organizational level. Each of these methods has its own problems and constraints that may become barriers to effective communication. Most of these barriers arise because of misinformation or lack of appropriate transparency available to the employees.

Attitude Barriers:

Certain people like to be left alone. They are the introverts or just people who are not very social. Others like to be social or sometimes extra clingy! Both these cases could become a barrier to communication. Some people have attitude issues, like huge ego and inconsiderate behaviors.

These employees can cause severe strains in the communication channels that they are present in. Certain personality traits like shyness, anger, social anxiety may be removable through courses and proper training. However, problems like egocentric behavior and selfishness may not be correctable.

Perception Barriers:

Different people perceive the same things differently. This is a fact which we must consider during the communication process. Knowledge of the perception levels of the audience is crucial to effective communication. All the messages or communicate must be easy and clear. There shouldn't be any room for a diversified interpretational set.

Physiological Barriers:

Certain disorders or diseases or other limitations could also prevent effective communication between the various channels of an organization. The shrillness of voice, dyslexia, etc are some examples of physiological barriers to effective communication. However, these are not crucial because they can easily be compensated and removed.

Technological Barriers & Socio-religious Barriers:

Other barriers include the technological barriers. The technology is developing fast and as a result, it becomes difficult to keep up with the newest developments. Hence sometimes the technological advance may become a barrier. In addition to this, the cost of technology is sometimes very high.

Most of the organizations will not be able to afford decent tech for the purpose of

communication. Hence, this becomes a very crucial barrier. Other barriers are socio-religious barriers. In a patriarchal society, a woman or a transgender may face many difficulties and barriers while communicating.

Source: Barriers of Communication: Types of Barriers to Effective Communication (toppr.com)

Remedies to overcome communication barriers

- **Be aware of language, message and tone:**

The sender should ensure that the message should be structured in clear and simple language. The tone of the message should not harm the feelings of the receiver. As far as possible, the contents of the message should be a concise and unnecessary use of technical words should be avoided.

- **Consult others before communication:**

When you're planning the communication, suggestions should be invited from all the individuals concerned. Its main benefit will be that all those people who are consulted at the time of the communication preparation will add to the success of the communication system.

- **Communicate according to the need of receiver:**

The sender of the communication should organize the formation of the message not according to his or her level, but he or she should keep in mind the point of understanding or the surroundings of the receiver.

- **Consistency of Message:**

The message sent to the receiver should not be self-opposing. It should be in unity with the objectives, programmes, policies and techniques of the organization. When new information has to be sent inlay of the old one, it should always make a declaration of the change; otherwise, it can raise some doubts and queries for the same.

- **Follow up Communication:**

In order to make communication successful, the management should frequently try to know the weaknesses of the communication structure. In this situation effort can be made to know whether to lay more hassle upon the formal or the informal communication would be suitable.

- **Make sure to receive proper feedback:**

The reason for feedback is to find out whether the receiver has appropriately understood the meaning of the information received. In face-to-face communication, the reply of the receiver can be understood. But in the case of written communication or other forms of communications, some correct process of feedback should be adopted by the sender.

Conclusion:

Communication is essential, that makes the moving parts of human relations function smoothly. Therefore, the meaning of communication cannot and should not be underestimated.

Source:

What are Communication Barriers & How to Overcome Them - Talent Economy
(shine.com)